Lecture 4 Slide Notes: Requirements Engineering

Slide 1: Why requirements matter

Most project failures trace back to requirements that were unclear, missing or changed late.

Slide 2: Elicitation techniques

- Interviews with the people who will use the product
- Surveys for reaching many users cheaply
- Observation of how users work today

Slide 3: Qualities of a good requirement

A good requirement is unambiguous, testable, necessary and feasible.

Words such as fast, easy and user-friendly are not testable until a number is attached to them.

Slide 4: Functional and non-functional requirements

A functional requirement says what the system does. A non-functional requirement says how well it does it, for example response time or capacity.

Slide 5: Prioritising with MoSCoW

- Must have: the product fails without it
- Should have: important but not vital
- Could have: nice to have if time allows
- Won't have: agreed to leave out for now

Slide 6: Reminder

The requirements specification is due on October 9. Bring your draft to class on October 6 for peer feedback.